



SHOTGUN

3D VISUAL DESIGN GUIDE

The premium automotive map look for Cruising and Navigate

CAMERA • 3D BUILDINGS • TERRAIN • LIGHTING • ROUTE • ALERTS

Visual direction | September 2026

1. The Shotgun 3D Look

A clean, dark, cinematic driving environment - premium, technical and unmistakably Shotgun.

The target is an automotive-style 3D map that feels closer to an in-car navigation display than a normal phone map. The road ahead is the hero. Buildings, terrain and scenery add depth, but never compete with the route, the vehicle or safety alerts.

Visual rule

The map should feel cinematic when parked, but extremely clear when moving. Depth and atmosphere are welcome; visual clutter is not.

- Near-black and graphite world with bright cyan navigation accents.
- Perspective view looking forward over the vehicle instead of a flat top-down map.
- 3D buildings in urban areas and shaped terrain on open roads.
- Road surfaces remain readable even when the surrounding environment is detailed.
- Alerts float naturally in the 3D scene without hiding the road.
- Minimal chrome: large map, compact controls, restrained information cards.



2. Camera & Driving Perspective

The camera is what creates the Tesla-like feeling.

The Shotgun view should sit behind and above the driver position, tilted toward the horizon. The car or navigation marker stays near the lower third of the screen, leaving most of the display available for the road ahead.

Situation	Camera feel	Visual effect
Cruising	Higher and wider	More surroundings and nearby alerts visible
Navigate	Lower and more forward	Route dominates and next manoeuvre feels closer
Highway speed	Longer look-ahead	Driver sees farther down the road
Intersection	Slightly higher	Turn geometry becomes easy to understand
City centre	Moderate tilt	Buildings create depth without blocking streets

A useful starting visual range is roughly 45-60 degrees of pitch, but the final feel should be tuned by eye. Camera movement should be smooth, not jumpy: position, heading, zoom and pitch all ease into their new state.

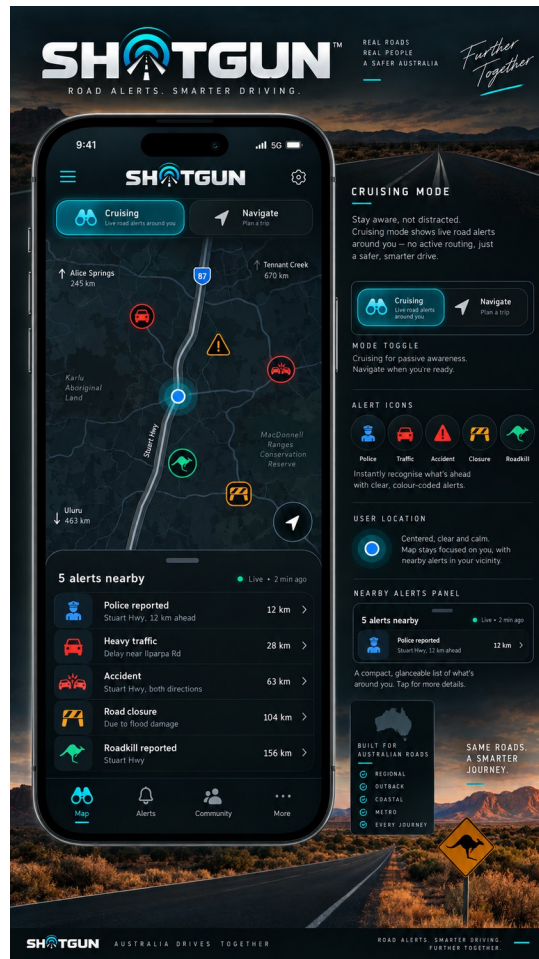
Composition
Keep the vehicle low. Keep the horizon visible. Give the driver maximum forward space.

3. Buildings, Terrain & Road Materials

3D detail should create depth, not become decoration.

Urban environments use dark 3D buildings with subtle edge lighting. Regional environments reduce building prominence and let terrain, road shape and horizon become the visual character. The map should transition naturally between those worlds.

- Buildings: charcoal/graphite, low saturation, restrained reflections.
- Road: slightly lighter than surrounding ground so the carriageway is always obvious.
- Terrain: dark natural forms with enough shading to read hills and valleys.
- Sky/horizon: very subtle gradient; avoid bright game-like skies.
- Shadows: soft and directional, used to reveal shape rather than create drama.
- Labels: minimal, high contrast, shown only where they help orientation.



4. Lighting & Colour Language

The environment stays quiet so Shotgun information can be loud.

The base map uses a dark neutral palette. Bright colours are reserved for meaning: cyan for Shotgun/navigation, blue for police, red for critical incidents, amber for caution/closures and green or yellow-green for animal/roadside hazards.

Purpose	Colour	Reference
Primary / route	Electric cyan	#00E6E6
Police	Cool blue	#2F8CFF
Crash / critical	Signal red	#FF4747
Closure / caution	Amber	#FFB02E
Animal / roadkill	Green	#26D99A
World / UI base	Near black	#0A1116

Night-driving principle

Do not illuminate the whole scene. Let cyan route light, alert markers and essential road edges do most of the visual work.

5. Route Line & Vehicle Styling

The route should look embedded in the road, not painted over the map.

Use a bright cyan route with a soft glow and a darker outer edge. It should follow the road precisely and remain visible beneath the vehicle. In 3D, the route can appear slightly luminous, but should not become a sci-fi laser beam.

- Primary route: solid cyan core with soft bloom.
- Alternative route: thinner or dashed teal/blue treatment.
- Completed route behind vehicle: reduced brightness.
- Vehicle marker: simple premium 3D car or sharp Shotgun navigation pointer.
- Vehicle halo: subtle cyan ring to anchor current position.
- Turn highlight: temporary increase in brightness approaching the manoeuvre.



6. Alert Markers in 3D

Alerts need to feel part of the road scene while remaining instantly recognisable.

Markers should be bold, simple and colour-coded, using the same visual language everywhere. In the 3D view they can sit slightly above their real-world road position with a small shadow/anchor, giving the impression that the alert belongs to that location.

Alert	Visual treatment	Priority feel
Police	Blue circular badge / police symbol	Clear but not alarming
Traffic	Red vehicle / congestion badge	Visible at medium distance
Accident	Red warning triangle	Strong visual priority
Road closure	Amber barrier	Strong route-impact cue
Roadkill / animal	Green or amber animal symbol	Highly visible on open roads
General hazard	Amber warning symbol	Flexible caution treatment

Distant alerts should be smaller and simpler. As the driver approaches, the marker grows slightly and a compact bottom card can appear. Avoid filling the screen with every report at the same visual weight.

7. Cruising vs Navigate - Visual Difference

Same world, two distinct personalities.

CRUISING • Wider view • Higher camera • No glowing destination route • More nearby alerts visible • Relaxed awareness feel	NAVIGATE • Lower forward camera • Bright route dominates • Next-turn card prominent • Route-relevant alerts prioritised • Focused driving feel
Transition Switching modes should feel like the same camera smoothly changing its attitude - not like opening a different app screen.	

8. UI Hierarchy & Screen Composition

The map owns the screen. UI sits on top only when it earns the space.

Shotgun should avoid a traditional dashboard packed with panels. The 3D map stays full-screen and primary controls float over it using dark translucent surfaces, soft borders and cyan focus states.

- Top: compact Cruising / Navigate switch.
- Navigate only: large next-turn instruction near top.
- Map centre: road, vehicle, route and spatial alerts.
- Bottom: one contextual card at a time - traffic, hazard, faster route, confirmation.
- Persistent buttons: Report and essential map controls only.
- Secondary settings stay hidden until requested.



9. The Final Shotgun Feel

A visual target for the finished product.

The finished 3D interface should feel like a premium Australian automotive navigation system: dark, calm, confident and highly legible. It should look impressive in screenshots, but its real strength should be how naturally the driver reads the road ahead at a glance.

Final visual target

A low forward camera. Dark 3D world. Cyan road guidance. Clean vehicle marker. Sparse floating alerts. Strong depth. Very little clutter. Shotgun branding visible through the visual language rather than oversized logos.

The concept images in this guide are design targets. The final production map may be slightly less cinematic than the artwork, but the same visual language - camera, depth, buildings, terrain, lighting, route and alert hierarchy - can be preserved.